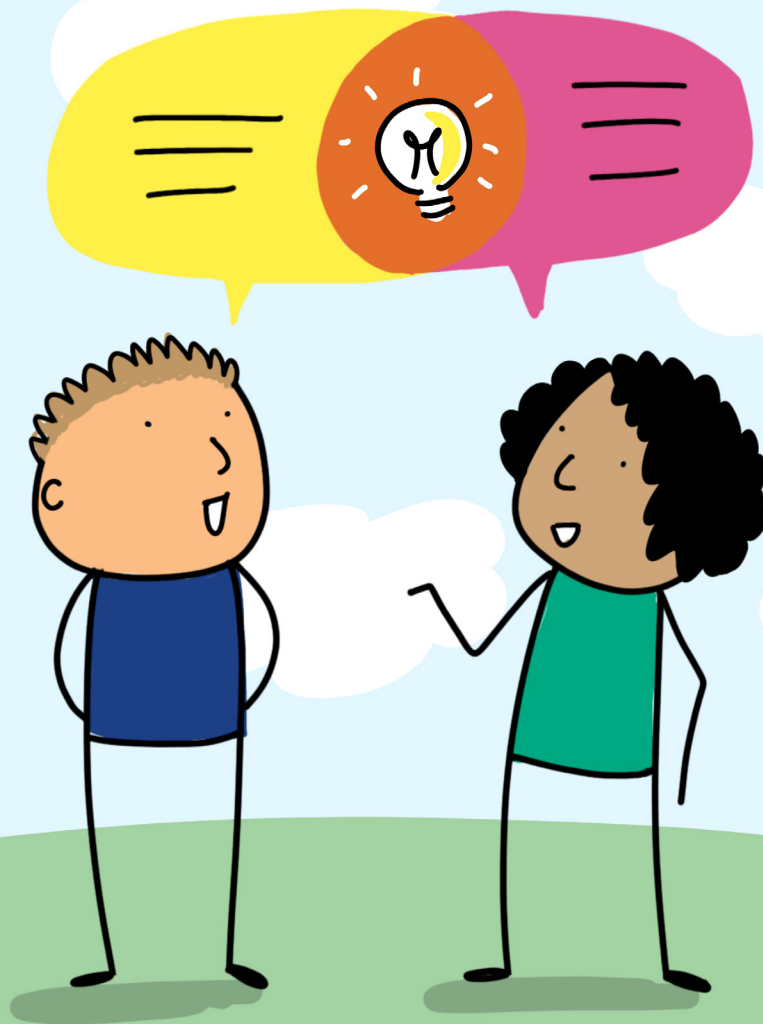




Columunity Playbook

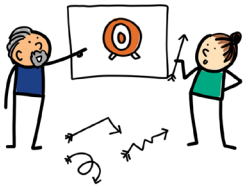
illustrations & worksheets

Hey change maker!

Welcome to your **Columinity** workbook!



Columinity helps teams and organizations use scientific insights to continuously improve how they work together. Teams collect perspectives from team members, supporters, and stakeholders to make sense of the results together and turn what they learn into experiments and concrete actions.



Columinity is more than a flat survey. Its purpose isn't simply to measure how teams are doing, but to **create meaningful change**. The data provides a starting point for conversations, helping teams learn, take action, and continuously improve how they work together.

This workbook brings together the illustrations and practical tools we use to support that process. Inside, you'll find:



- **How to get started** with Columinity, from preparing the implementation to evaluating progress
- The **3 scientific models** that form the foundation of Columinity
- The **10 principles** for using Columinity effectively
- The **Kickoff Canvas** to help teams prepare for their first diagnosis to action and evaluate what happens next

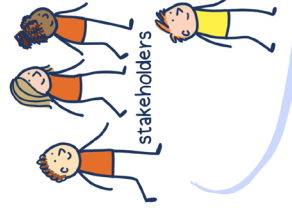


We hope you'll return to this workbook as you continue learning about your teams and organization. Because there's always something to improve!



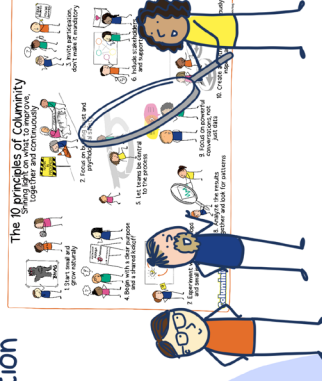
How to get started with Columinity?

Diagnose your team(s) with a scientifically validated approach, inspect the results together, and improve with evidence-based feedback



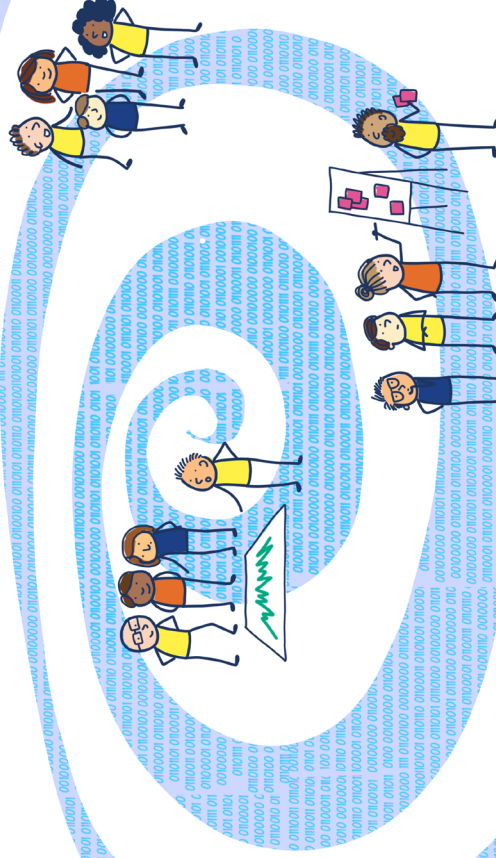
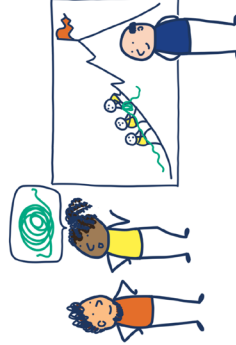
1 Create an implementation plan

Identify a strategy for a successful implementation



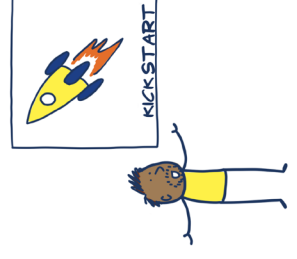
4 Evaluate progress

Inspect what changed over time, and identify new actions



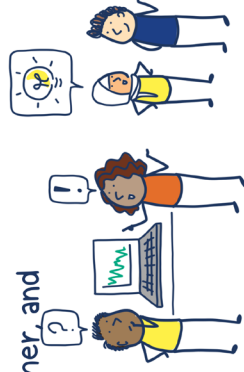
2 Facilitate a kickoff

Kickstart the use of Columinity with teams, stakeholders, and supporters

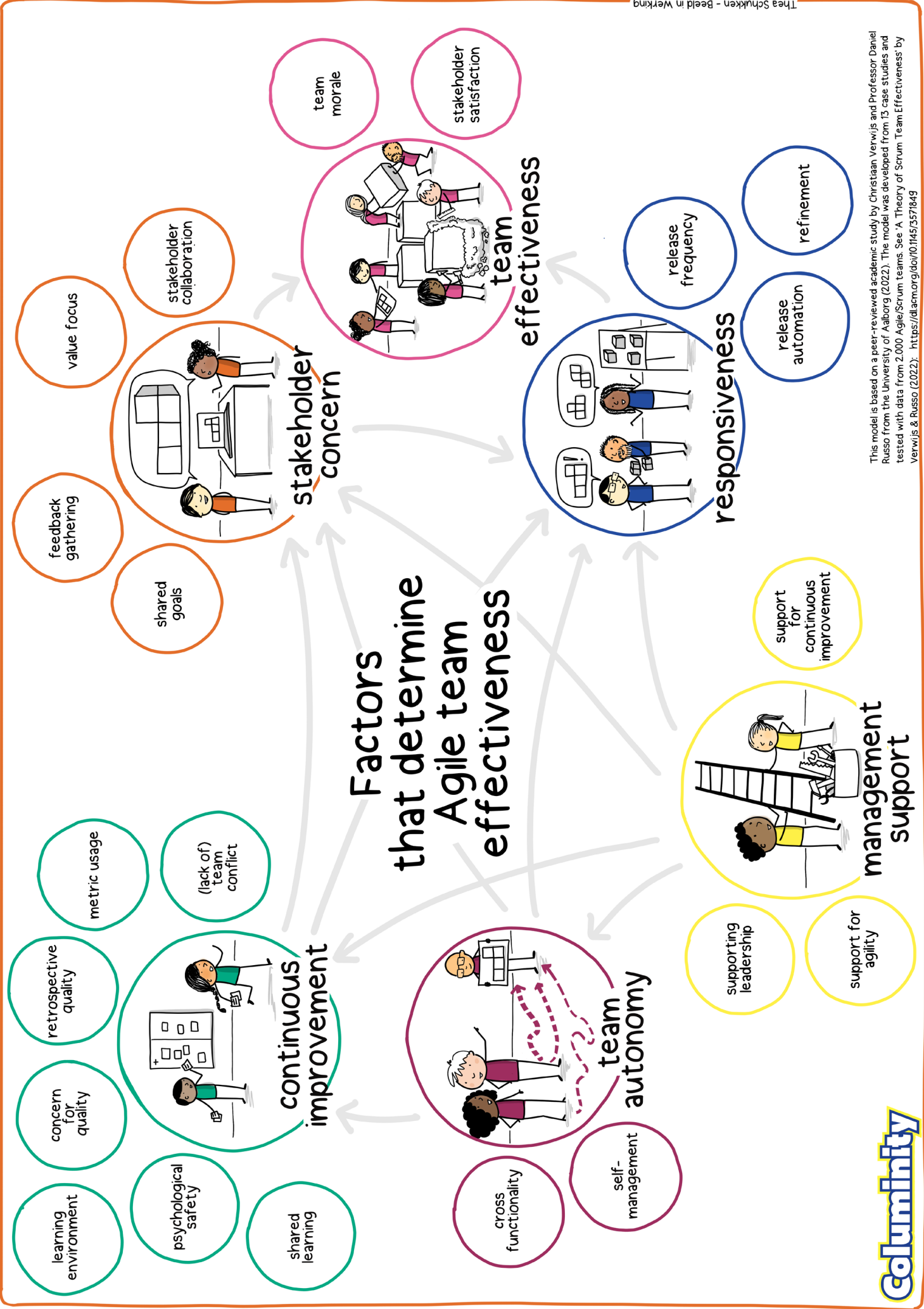


3 Inspect & Improve

Make sense of the results together, and translate insights into action



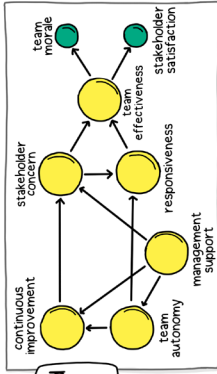
Columinity



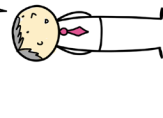
What Makes Agile Teams Effective?

FINDING 1

Five factors explain a substantial part of Agile team effectiveness

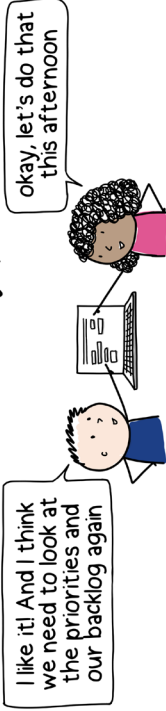


can't we just send our teams to an Agile bootcamp?



FINDING 2

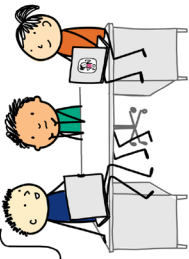
The most effective Agile teams release at least every sprint



FINDING 3

Shared Product Ownership is essential

as a team, we like to work very closely together with our customers



FINDING 4

Team autonomy and Continuous Improvement create the right conditions for effective Agile teams

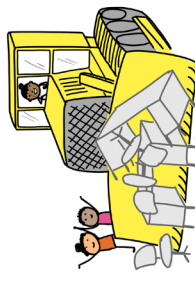
RETROSPECTIVE # 16

TEAM AUTONOMY PLAYLIST
I want to break-free
another brick in the wall
ain't nothin' gonna break my stride
born to run



FINDING 5

Management needs to create the right environment

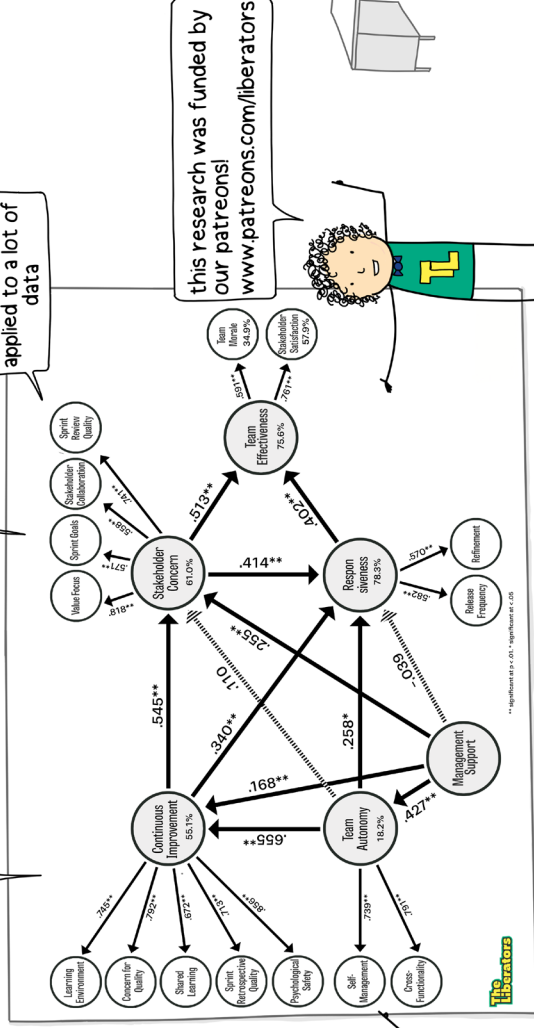


Based on data from 2000 Agile teams

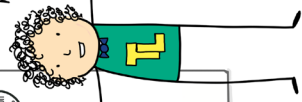


read the academic paper on <https://theliberatorsimproveyourteam.com/research>

scientific methods applied to a lot of data



this research was funded by our patrons! www.patreons.com/liberators



Christiaan Verwijs

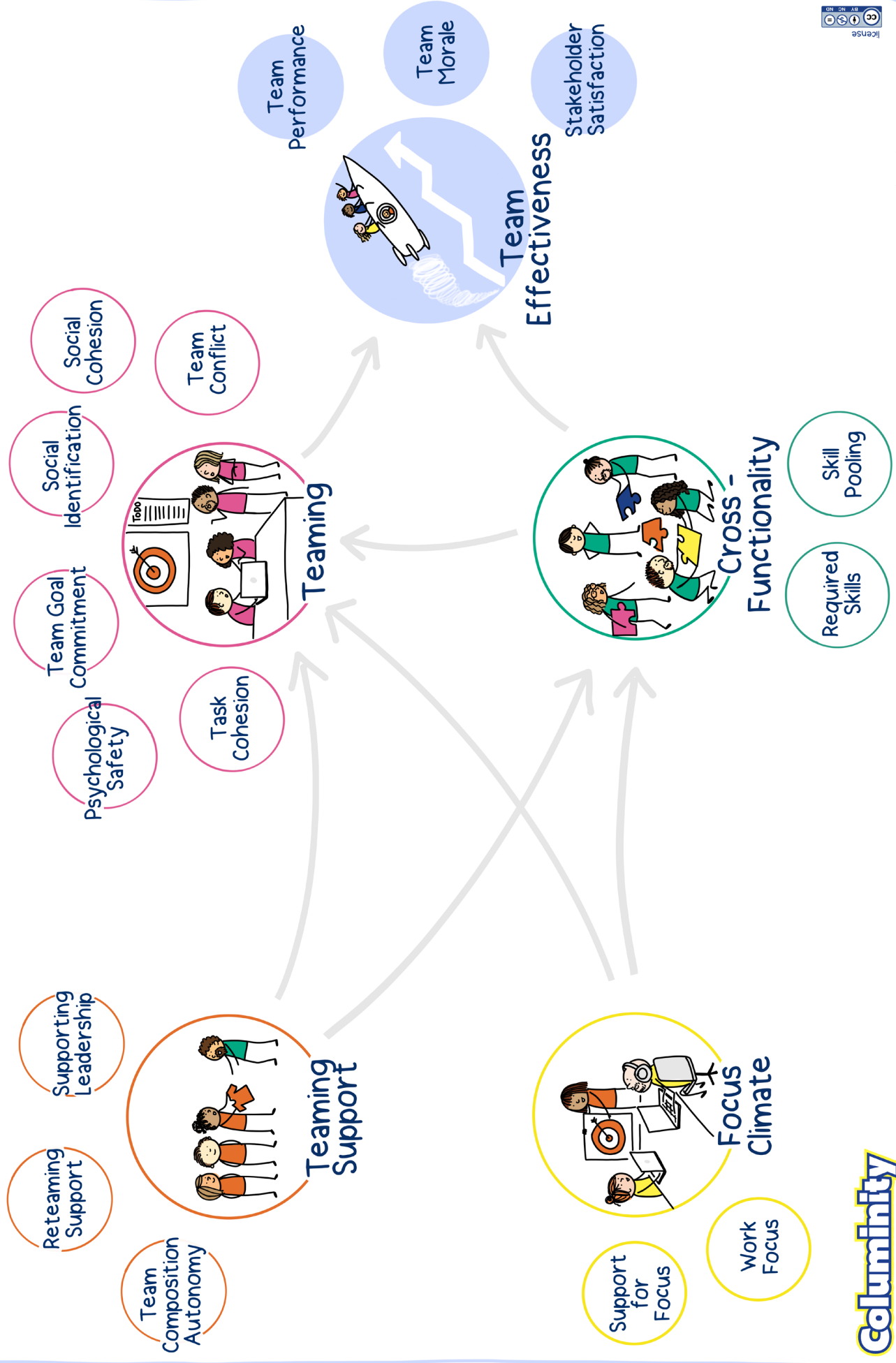
Daniel Russo
Professor at Aalborg University

Columinity

This model is based on a peer-reviewed academic study by Christiaan Verwijs and Professor Daniel Russo from the University of Aalborg (2022). The model was developed from 13 case studies and tested with data from 2,000 Agile/Scrum teams. See 'A Theory of Scrum Team Effectiveness' by Verwijs & Russo (2022): <https://doi.org/10.1145/3571849>

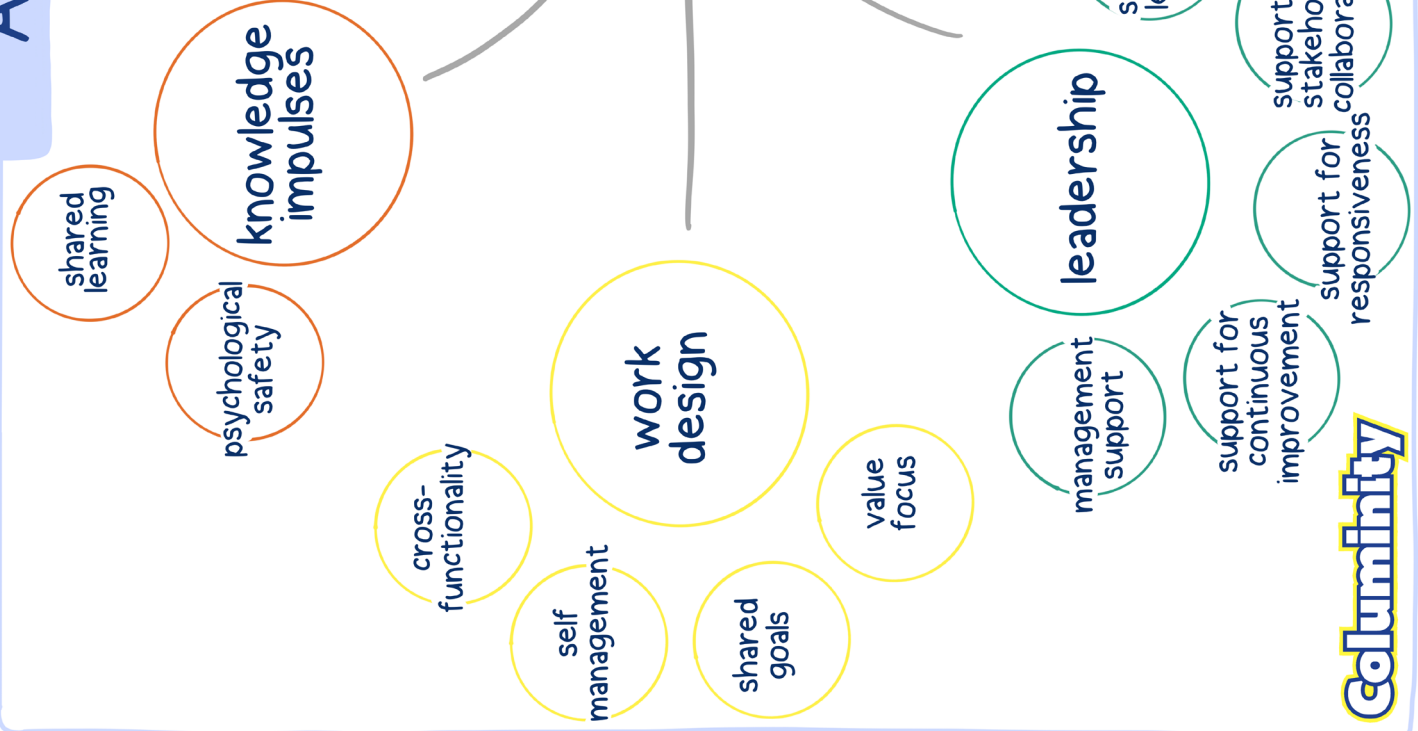
Thea Schukken - Beeld in Werking

Teaming Success Model



Agile Mindset Model

BETA

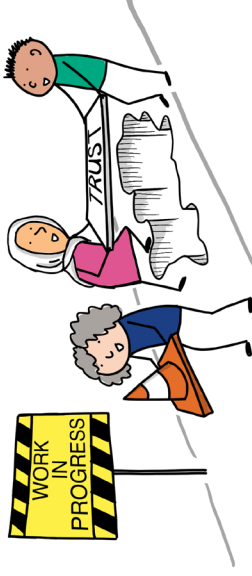


The 10 principles of Columinity

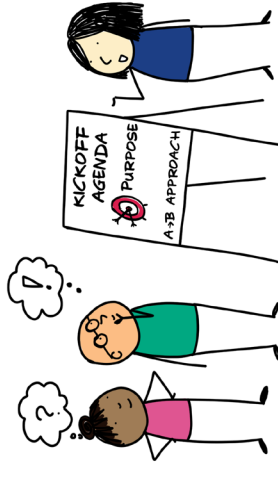
Shining light on what to improve, together and continuously



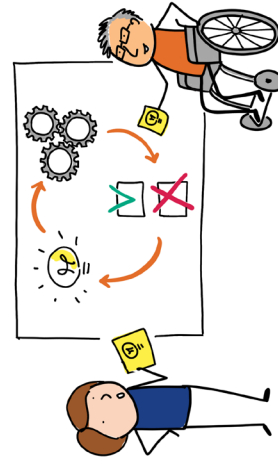
1. Start with purpose and ambition



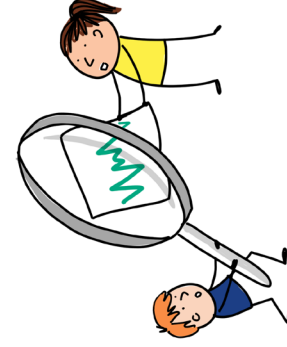
2. Focus on building trust and psychological safety



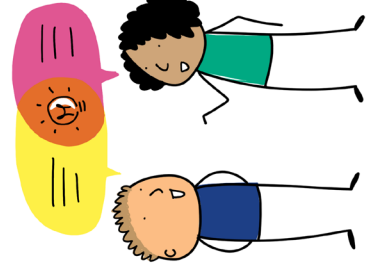
4. Begin with a shared kickoff



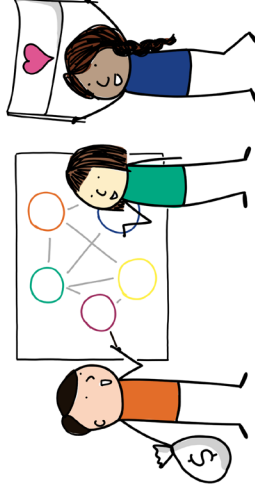
7. Experiment with workshops and small improvements



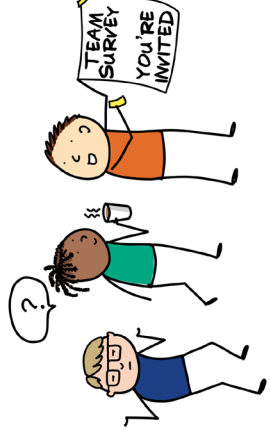
8. Analyze the results together and look for patterns



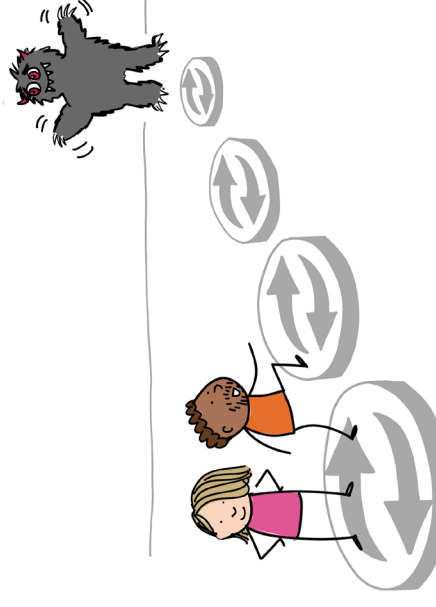
9. Focus on powerful conversations, not just data



6. Include stakeholders and supporters



3. Invite participation, don't make it mandatory



10. Create a rhythm to continuously inspect and adapt

Columinity Kickoff Canvas

Our purpose with Columinity is to ...



Team members:

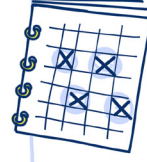


Stakeholders:



Supporters:

A good way of working is:



Important principles are:





Team Report Checklist



1. About your team scan

How many team members participated in the scan?

Is the participation rate high enough to consider it meaningful?

What are the three main focus areas identified?

How does your team's effectiveness score compare to the benchmark(s)?



2. Looking at the results

Which three factors have the highest scores?

Which three factors have the lowest scores?

Which factors show the least variation in participants' responses?

Which factors show the most variation in participants' responses?

Which stakeholder results are most notable?

Which supporter results are most notable?



3. Signals and flags

Which factors are marked as impediments?

Which badges has your team earned?



4. If your team conducted multiple team scans

Which factors have increased since the previous scan?

Which factors have decreased since the previous scan?

Which factors show little or no change since the previous scan?



5. If your team has set an improvement goal

Which factors related to the improvement goal have changed since the previous scan?



6. What else do you notice?

Anything else that stands out, surprises you, or is worth exploring further?

What, So What, Now What? - Worksheet

Create shared understanding and decide how to move forward

What?

What do we notice?



So what?

So what does this mean?



Now what?

Now what actions make sense?



Identify Your Research Question

What is our concern, problem, or challenge?



Why is this challenge worth investigating?
What would resolving make possible?



If you could frame the challenge as a question for
learning and exploration, what would it be?



Action Research



try it with
your team

Diagnose

What stands out from the results?
What do we notice?

What underlying causes, mechanisms, or
triggers could explain our observations?



Act

What improvement actions could make
a positive difference?

What would be good first,
small next steps?



Evaluate

What do we need to observe to know we
are improving? What might interfere?

When do we start a new learning cycle?
Who do we need to involve? What other
sources should we investigate?



Action Research - Identify Improvement Actions



What is the improvement action?

What is the type of action?

- ☐ Initiate a conversation
- ☐ Request help outside team
- ☐ Run an experiment
- ☐ Research options
- ☐ Facilitate a workshop
- ☐ Other

What factor(s) do you expect to improve?

What support is needed from others?

Who owns this action?

When should it be done?



What Have We Learned?

What do we know now, that we didn't know before?



Why is this valuable new knowledge?



What advice can we give other teams or organizations?











